

Neurology Specialty Pharmacist Interventions for Integrated Health System Specialty Pharmacy vs. Non-Integrated Health System Pharmacy Patients



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PURPOSE

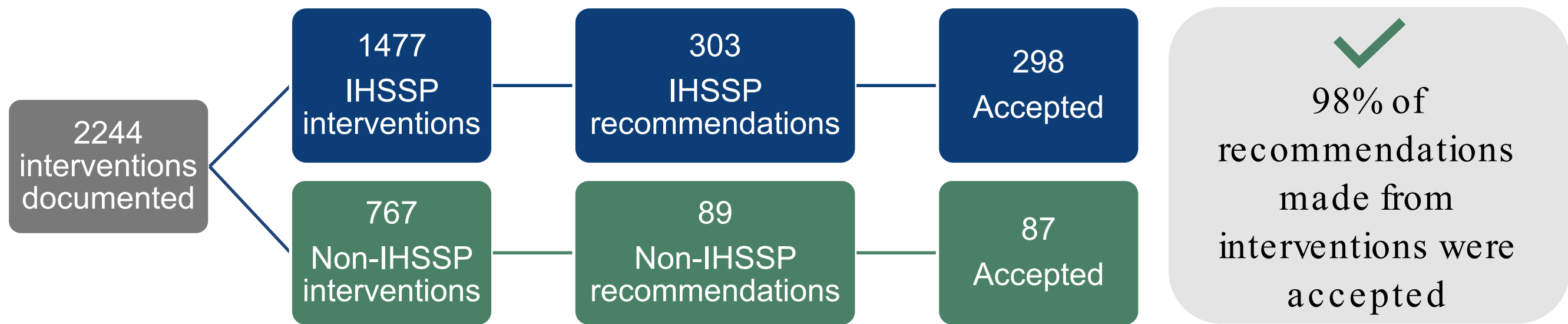
Specialty pharmacists guide treatment selection and manage medications for patients with non-MS neurologic conditions, even when patients fill prescriptions at external pharmacies due to payer restrictions or personal choice.

Research is needed to understand the services pharmacists at integrated health system specialty pharmacies (IHSSP) provide for these patients and the impact on their workload.

METHODS

Study Design	Objective	Sample	Outcomes
Single-center retrospective study January 1, 2023, to March 31, 2023 Interventions extracted from the electronic health record and specialty pharmacy software	Evaluate differences in interventions performed by a specialty pharmacist for patients filling at an IHSSP versus non-IHSSP pharmacies	All patients prescribed a specialty medication from non-MS neurology clinics at Vanderbilt University Medical Center with at least one pharmacist intervention	Compare the number, type, impact score, and time spent on interventions for patients filling at an IHSSP compared to those filling at non-IHSSP pharmacies Evaluate number of interventions performed and recommendations made and accepted <i>Recommendation</i> = provider contacted regarding potential therapy change or additional monitoring

Figure 1. Interventions performed



CONCLUSIONS

- Non-IHSSP patients needed more financial assistance and prescription transfers
- Non-IHSSP interventions required more pharmacists' time
- Almost all intervention recommendations were accepted by providers

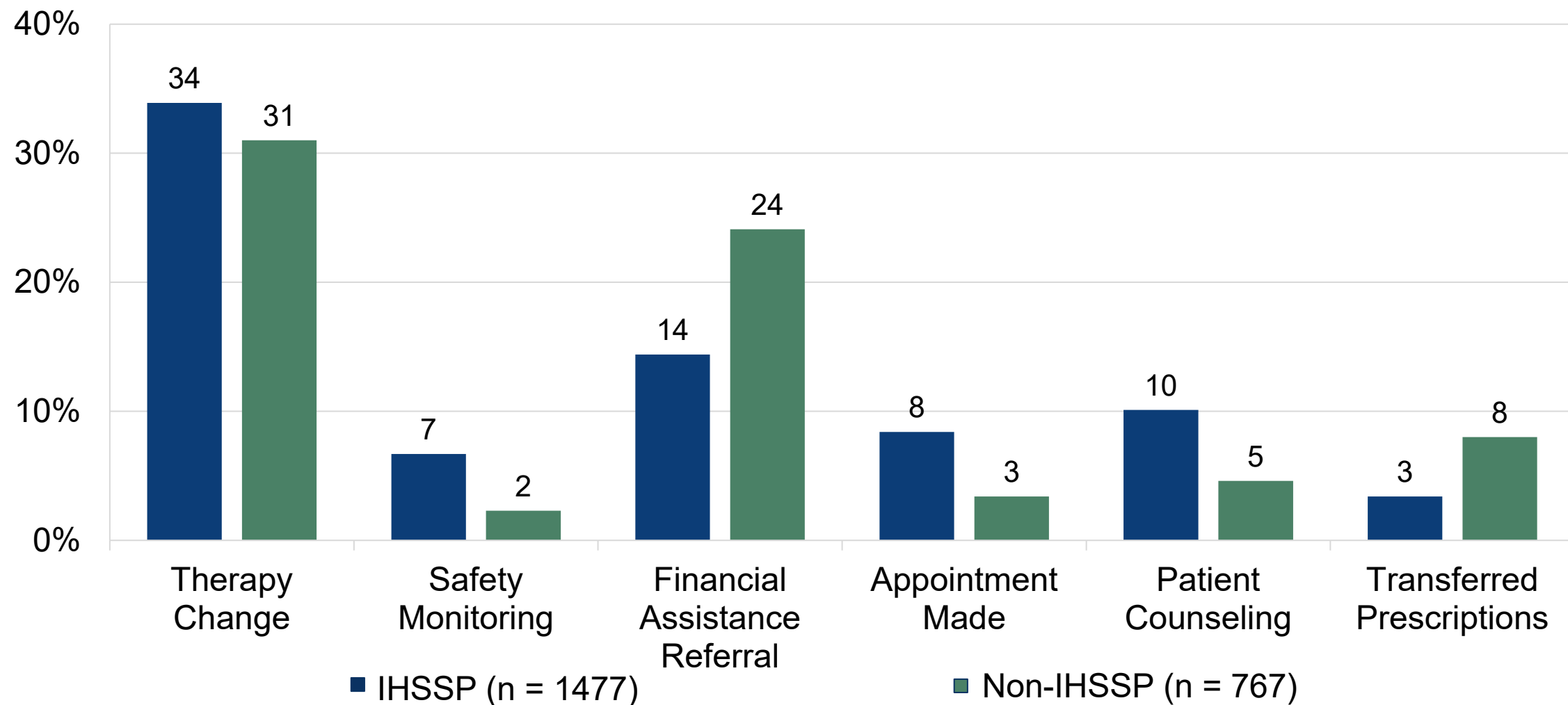
RESULTS

Table 1. Baseline Patient Demographics

	Non-IHSSP n = 230 n (%)	IHSSP n = 511 n (%)
Age, Median [IQR]	58 [25-71]	61 [20-73]
Sex		
Female	100 (44)	234 (46)
Male	130 (57)	276 (54)
Race		
White	181 (82)	418 (84)
African American	19 (9)	51 (10)
Primary Insurance		
Commercial	120 (52)	111 (22)
Government/Other	110 (48)	400 (78)

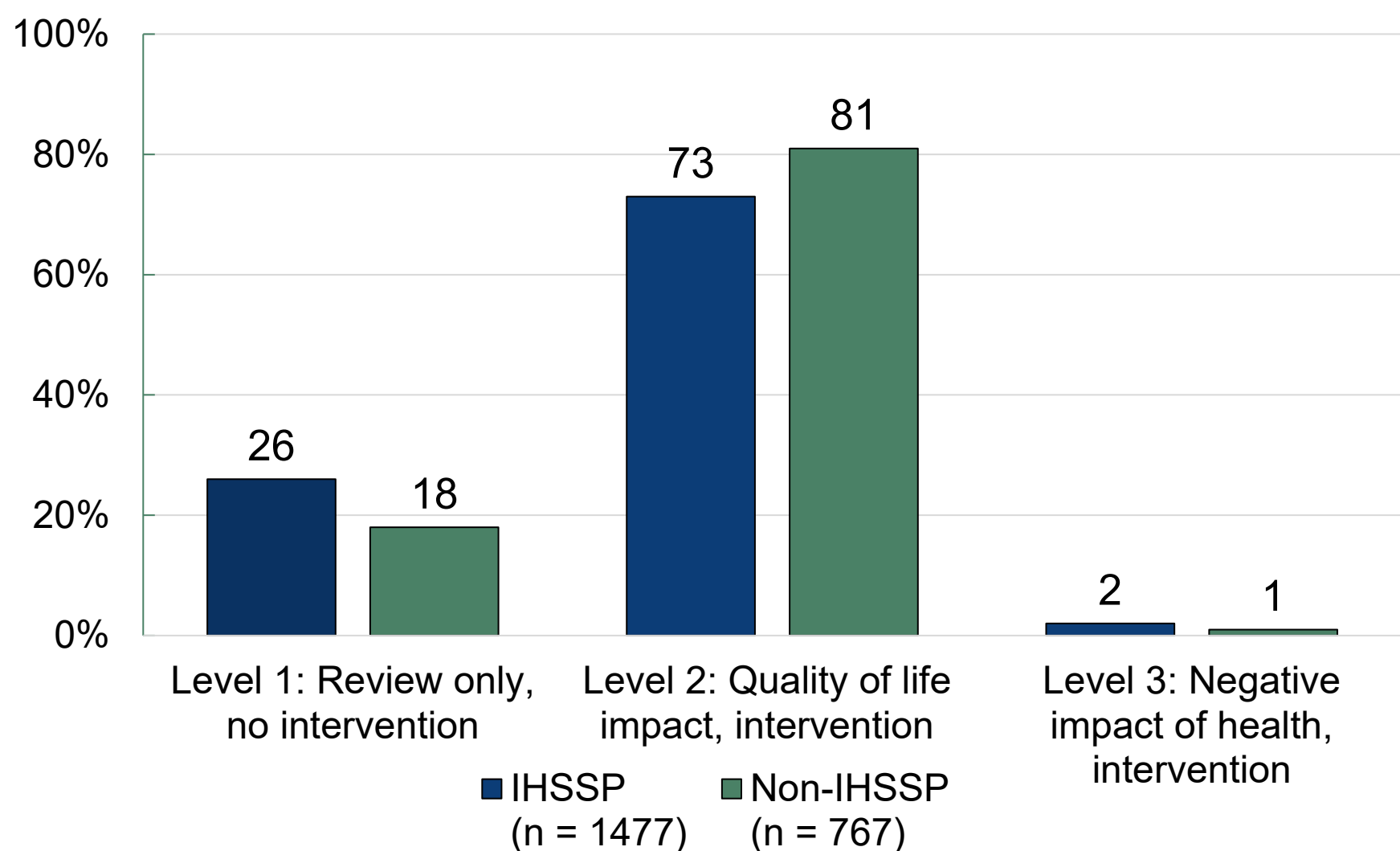
IQR = Interquartile Range

Figure 2. Type of Pharmacist Interventions



- IHSSP patients had more clinical interventions such as safety monitoring, counseling, and making appointments
- Non-IHSSP patients required more financial assistance interventions and work to transfer prescriptions

Figure 3. Intervention Impact Scores

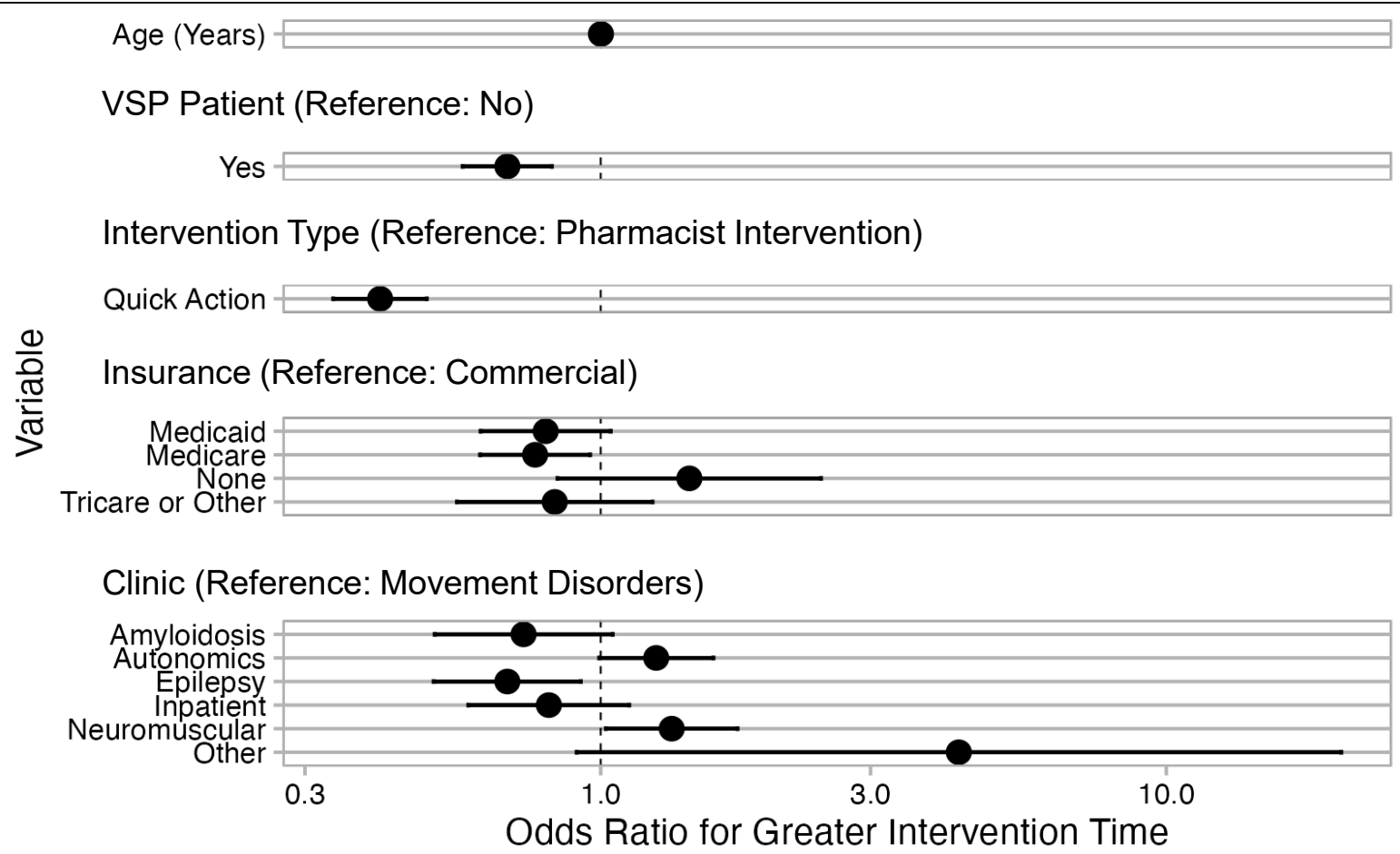


Impact scores are assigned by the pharmacist performing the intervention at the time of the intervention. Level 4 Impact Score was never required

Most interventions were noted to likely impact patients' quality of life

IHSSP pharmacists perform interventions that have an impact on patients regardless of where they fill their neurology specialty medication

Figure 4. Regression Analysis on Intervention Time



IHSSP patients had shorter intervention times
IHSSP: median 8 minutes, IQR 5–15
Non-IHSSP patients: median 10 minutes, IQR 5–15
p<0.001